

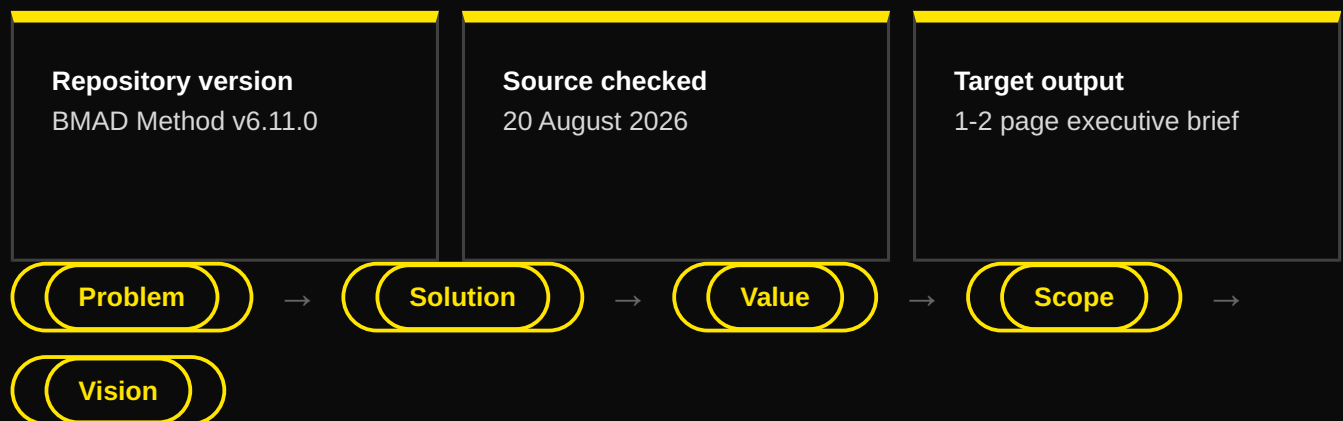
BMAD METHOD

TEACHING EDITION - CURRENT MAIN BRANCH

Product Brief

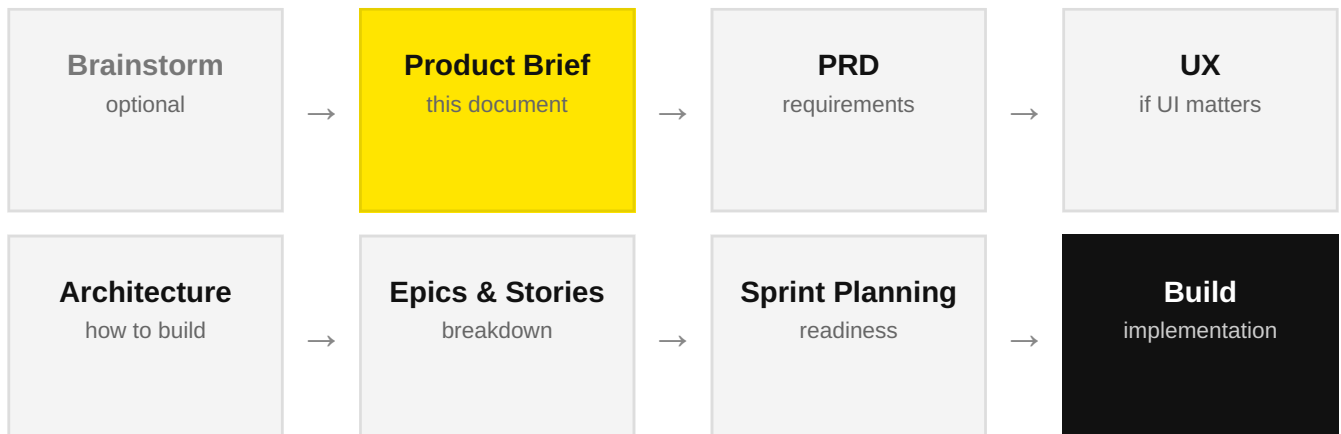
From idea to a crisp product story

A student-friendly guide and worksheet based on the current BMAD Method product brief template.



The current BMAD planning path

In BMAD v6.11.0, the artifact is implemented as **bmad-product-brief**. It is a guided conversation that captures the product idea before detailed requirements. BMAD also offers PRFAQ as an alternative way to challenge the concept.



BMAD's design principle

The template is a **starting structure, not a contract**. Drop sections that add no value, add sections the product needs, and reorder when the story is clearer another way.

Keep it brief

The current skill aims for roughly **1-2 pages**. Deeper material belongs in supporting notes or downstream artifacts such as the PRD and architecture.

For students: the goal is not to fill boxes. The goal is to make the product understandable enough that another person can explain what it is, who needs it, and what success means.

Seven questions the brief must answer

The current default template uses seven sections. Each section earns its place by answering a different decision-making question.

1 Executive Summary

What is this, what problem does it solve, and why now?

2 The Problem

Who is hurting, what happens today, and what does the status quo cost?

3 The Solution

What experience or outcome will change for the user?

4 What Makes This Different

Why this approach instead of the alternatives?

5 Who This Serves

Who are the primary users and what does success look like for them?

6 Success Criteria

What measurable signals tell us the product is working?

7 Scope + Vision

What is inside the first version, what is outside, and what could this become if it succeeds?

GOOD BRIEF

specific

measurable

bounded

user-centered

honest

Make the whole idea understandable at a glance

What belongs here?

- What the product is
- The problem it addresses
- Why it matters to the intended users
- Why this is worth doing now

Useful formula

For [user], we are creating [product] that helps them [outcome], because today [pain]. Now matters because [trigger/opportunity].

Coach yourself

Could someone read only this section and still explain your vision accurately?

Avoid starting with features. Start with purpose, problem and outcome.

Draft your executive summary

Quality check: 2-3 compact paragraphs. Clear enough to stand alone. No unexplained jargon.

Start with the pain - then describe the change

A

The Problem

Describe the real situation before your product exists.

- Who experiences the pain?
- What do they do today?
- What is frustrating, slow, expensive or risky?
- What happens if nothing changes?

B

The Solution

Describe what improves when the product exists.

- What are you building?
- What will users be able to do differently?
- What result or experience improves?
- What should you deliberately avoid specifying yet?

Problem statement

Solution statement

Important: BMAD's template explicitly keeps the Solution focused on the **experience and outcome**, not implementation detail. Technology choices can come later.

Why this product - and for whom?

What Makes This Different

Compare your approach with the user's real alternatives - including doing nothing, spreadsheets, manual work, competitors, or an existing system.

Ask: Why would a user switch? What advantage can we defend? What is merely a hope?

Who This Serves

Keep the audience vivid but brief. Focus on needs and behavior rather than demographic decoration.

Ask: Who feels the problem most? What are they trying to accomplish? What would success look like in their day?

Alternative today	Why users tolerate it	Why our approach is better

Primary user in one sentence

Honesty rule: do not invent a "moat". If the advantage is better execution, a tighter workflow, domain expertise, or speed, say that plainly.

Turn "good" into observable evidence

Success criteria should combine **user success** and **product/business success**. Use signals you can actually observe.

01 User outcome

What gets easier, faster, safer or more successful?

02 Behavior

What action shows that users value the product?

03 Quality

What must remain reliable, accurate or usable?

04 Business / mission

What outcome justifies continuing investment?

Signal	Metric / evidence	Target	When measured
User outcome			
Adoption / behavior			
Quality / trust			
Business / mission			

A brief is also a boundary document

The first version becomes clearer when you state both what is included and what is deliberately excluded. Keep this at capability level - not a giant feature backlog.

IN - first version

Essential capabilities required to prove the core value.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

OUT - not now

Tempting ideas that would dilute the first version.

1.

2.

3.

4.

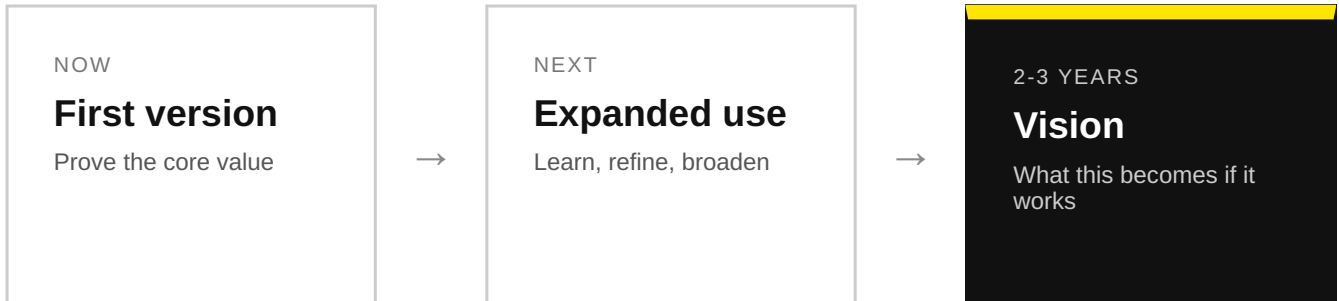
5.

Scope test

If removing an item still allows you to test the core value proposition, it probably does not belong in version one.

Remember: BMAD describes scope as a boundary, not a feature list. The detailed requirements belong in the PRD.

Show where success could lead



Vision statement

Inspiring

Make the future meaningfully better than today. Show the destination, not just the next release.

Grounded

Do not turn the vision into fantasy. It should plausibly grow from the problem, users and first-version value.

Can the brief survive a skeptical reader?

- ☐ **Clarity:** A reader understands the product without a verbal explanation.
- ☐ **Problem evidence:** The pain is concrete, not generic.
- ☐ **Outcome focus:** The solution describes changed experience before technology.
- ☐ **Differentiation:** Alternatives are acknowledged honestly.
- ☐ **Users:** The primary audience is specific enough to design for.
- ☐ **Success:** At least a few signals are measurable.
- ☐ **Scope:** Version one has explicit boundaries.
- ☐ **Vision:** The 2-3 year direction is ambitious but believable.
- ☐ **Length:** The final executive brief can be distilled to about 1-2 pages.

Common failure modes

- Writing a feature list instead of a product story
- Using "everyone" as the target user
- Claiming differentiation without comparing alternatives
- Success criteria that cannot be measured
- Letting version one include the whole roadmap
- Explaining architecture before proving the need

Build a brief in 20 minutes

0-3 Brain dump: product, user, pain, and why
minutes now.

3-7 Write Problem + Solution. Remove
minutes implementation details.

7-11 Name alternatives, differentiation, and
minutes primary user.

11-15 Define success signals and version-one
minutes boundaries.

15-18 Write the 2-3 year Vision.
minutes

18-20 Write the Executive Summary last; then
minutes cut anything nonessential.

Peer review - 3 questions

1. What problem do you think this product solves?
2. What is the single biggest assumption in the brief?
3. What would you remove from version one?

Source basis

This teaching PDF is an adaptation of the current BMAD Method repository, not an official BMAD publication. Source checked on 20 August 2026.

Version: package.json reports v6.11.0 (released 9 Aug 2026).

Current skill: src/bmm-skills/plan/bmad-product-brief/

Template: assets/brief-template.md

Workflow catalog: src/bmm-skills/module-help.csv

github.com/bmad-code-org/BMAD-METHOD

Product Brief:

Executive Summary

What is it? What problem? Why does it matter? Why now?

The Problem

Who hurts, what happens today, and what is the cost?

The Solution

What changes for the user? Focus on experience and outcome.

What Makes This Different

Why this instead of the real alternatives?

Who This Serves

Primary user, need, and what success looks like.

Success Criteria

Observable user + product/business signals.

Scope

IN for v1 / OUT for v1.

Vision

What could this become in 2-3 years if it succeeds?

Final test: Can this be distilled into a clear 1-2 page executive brief?